my Theory of Consciousness, Awareness, Ego & Oneness

Consciousness, Oneness - overused words with meanings, many.
But it doesn't matter what they are considered to be, how they are understood & perceived by everyone.
For they are not read, rationalised or understood.
They are realised.
They have to arise from within to make any real sense - I write, as I begin my essay on those very topics!

The Paradox! A fortunate accident - the introduction embodying the very Paradox of the Subject!

I consider myself very lucky to have been put on this path of self-inquiry & to have had the realization that Oneness (internal) - “Sahyujyam” as the spiritual, fundamental & ultimate purpose of Life. I also am blessed to have had the freedom & space in mind to venture into the rabbit hole.

This essay for me is a synthesis of epiphanies and realisations I have been blessed with over time; These are ideas that have manifested in me, that I have contended with internally & that have eventually taken a coherent shape.

The purpose of writing it - for myself more than anything else - expression & manifestation of what has been brewing within me for a while now, with not much expectations, other than maybe, at least one or two people indulging in & engaging with, but not necessarily.

Let us begin with - what is Consciousness?
At this point, I'm not going to define it based on human experience. We will save it for later.
Let's go top down first.

For me Consciousness is at the helm, widespread.

Consciousness is
The Zero Sum, Infinite Potential, Energy Field;

Chaos that contains Everything - All the Infinite Possibilities - Each manifesting as temporary order pockets - each balancing the other - Amounting to a net Nothing - maintaining the Zero Sum.

Nothing , that contains Everything.
Non Duality, that births & is perpetuated by Duality.
Silence within which reverberates infinite sounds & noises.

A self powering & self sustaining system that relies on Duality & Order, the antithesis to its own Non dual Chaos to introduce polarity , movement & manifestations.

The Self, personified as Krishnā or Kāli , the twins.

Awareness - A necessary emergent property of Consciousness, its “Alter-ego” if you will;
The Duality, The Intent, The Desire for Order, that drives the construction of Order out of & within the Chaos it resides in.
Awareness, the Spark from which begin ‘Everything’;
A spark born from the opposing force of the desire for order in an innately chaotic Consciousness,
The Force that drives Creation & Order.
The One, Personified by ShivaShakti,
The Duality captured in the two sexes contained in one body.

God - is this Consciousness, Awareness, not a human, not a manifested entity - but The Self & The One - driving these manifestations. The various personifications presented by our scriptures, point to these ultimate truths. They are not simply stories. Stories are merely the vessels - yes they have been borrowed from the realities of their time, based upon people of the time & also a tool to inform generations on how Life was then - but they are the shallow byproducts - deeper is the tattva, the fundamentals of Consciousness that they point to. When we say Krishnā, Murugā, Shivā, the purpose is not to think of the character built by the poets & thinkers in their stories, but to remember the Infinite Consciousness that they all point to.

From & within Consciousness, driven by Awareness , forms the various Order Pockets, abstraction machines - from particles, stars, planets to beings - Order - boundaries , generated within the Chaos, by expelling/ pushing away the Chaos outside of itself. ‘A being’ - more abstracted, deeper into the matrix than a star, a step in the Awareness's search for absolute Order.

But the paradox manifests again - Every order created, generates more chaos around , within the Zero sum Infinite - everything gets balanced, making the Awareness's drive for Absolute Order a pipe dream - always searching, never reaching.
Order always remaining in pockets - temporary, deepening the abstraction, until Chaos devours ,and new order pockets start growing in its place - infinite order pockets being born, growing , dying & reborn infinite times over.

These Order Pockets - The Many - manifesting as Universes(super order pockets), Particles (sub order packets), Stars, Planets, RNA-DNA-Beings , Art/Math/language - born out of the paradoxical non-Oneness of Consciousness & Awareness - The Self/ Consciousness’s own

creation to sustain itself , the Awareness/The One's own manifestations as "The Many" - are what we are, Everything is.

We - Universe, particles, stars, DNA, plants, things, you , me are all The Many manifestations of Awareness, made of ,from & within Consciousness. The same, with different variables , each an experiment so to speak, maybe Awareness's own search for oneness through trillions of particles & lives. Humans are the micro sub set of order pockets.
Even Math, Art , AI are all also micro order pockets - abstractions - attempting to turn the subjective infinity into human accessible, understandable finitudes (still not objectivity - no such thing!).

Now that we have journeyed through Consciousness manifesting as Awareness & Awareness manifesting as order pockets , with this Universe being one of the infinite temporary super order pockets that contains within it sub, super sub order pockets , let's call God in.

God clearly is Consciousness , Awareness - and is God actively sitting and building this order, making individual decisions? Controlling everything?
God, being God has a more robust solution - a self regulating system - the governing principles? Karma, Probability. Karma - Equal and opposite reaction for every action , probability - built in indeterminacy/unpredictability/uncertainty - two simple, deep principles - keeping balance, ensuring zero sum.

But the story doesn't end here. This system of Consciousness - Awareness - Manifestations also produce emergent phenomena and properties. Paradox appears once again. These emergent Properties of Order are also the tools that propagate the order it came from.

Space, Time, Gravity - emergent properties of Universe - atleast This Universe - this Super Order Pocket - more straightforward, widely understood - with the birth of order & particles emerge these big three - and they are not only born out of Order, they also create order, in the usual Paradoxical style. These facilitate order, carry order, carry on order, define constraints - Order aides, Order outcomes.

But it doesn't stop here.
As Order grows deeper into the abstraction matrix, as order gets 'condensed' so to speak, more emergent properties that are also tools of propagation of its source, seem to emerge (see, cyclic, self referential loops everywhere!). I say seem to , because, do they really emerge in more abstracted order pockets or simply more observable in these order pockets? We will get to that.

Beings, our specific set of Order Pocket - A sub order within this Universe - seem to have some additional emergent properties - Life, Perceived Collective Reality, Subjective Experience, Thought.

In general parlance - it is this Subjective Experience - that is called Consciousness. Ha ha - talk about us being abstraction machines - always finding truth in buckets instead of the Ocean! But let's not confuse Consciousness & Subjective Experience, at least for the course of this particular thought journey.

Consciousness Is.
Subjective Experience emerges-

- from, within, by, for Consciousness itself, in its own paradoxical way.

But, before we move forward. Let's pause a moment and question - are these emergent properties - Life, Perceived collective reality, subjective experience, Thought, are all additional ones only applicable to this super suborder pocket called humans? Or even to only the suborder pocket called beings? Or is it also Universal like the other emergent phenomena?

The unfortunate state of matter is, we humans are delusional to the point of arrogance to think it is only us that experience Life, that thought is our special domain.
This idea that these emergent properties only apply to our own super suborder pocket stems from that delusion & arrogance. This is to be noted.

Subjective Experience cannot be understood or measured, to the extent that, even between two humans , in love, speaking the same language, raised in fairly similar conditions, even when communicating clearly cannot fully , truly understand or experience or measure the other's subjective experiences. I could tell you I am in immense pain , but you can never feel my pain, know my pain, what is my pain, how much pain is immense, how is the calculation of how much done - all of it is completely subjective & unique.

Now we are dense (condensed order pockets we are, afterall!) to the point that we cannot fathom the Subjective Experience of even a friend. So, we find it even easier to declare that other Animals, than humans, don't experience Life, they don't know Death, they don't think, etc . Or if we are one of those open minded kinds - we extend what we consider an honor , to mammals or ‘higher beings’.
But, let's step out of this arrogance, this delusion and think about it.

Let's start with Sense of Self - what is this - why is this?
The sense of self has layers to it. It most fundamentally begins at RNA-DNA level. We each have DNA, our genetic code that is safeguarded within the nucleus. And our body actively filters out external DNA, from mixing with our own, unless during procreation. That is not to say that our DNA is static or is immune to changes. It very much is - it expresses itself in various ways dependent on every external factor, and gets updated, loses information, etc.
But, not getting adulterated randomly by random unknown strings of DNA is not something that the DNA/organism wishes for - this is Immunity - organisms building some mechanism to filter out the other, which starts with the knowledge of Self. This immunity, this sense of self, this

desire to keep others out is seen in every being, starting with the first RNA strands that brought Life , single celled organisms to you and me.
Sense of Self not unique to humans, not unique to higher animals. Sense of self is a fundamental phenomena of Life, and that which sustains and propagates Life too - because Life started with desire to stay, survive, it started with an I.

Now the Sense of Self that starts with DNA identifying self & other, goes on to define the edges of the being - the body parts, where they end, where they begin, a map of our body - this is also seen in every being - even a prokaryotic single celled organism builds flagella - arm/leg like filaments using protein, creates a flux in the environment to rotate the flagella like a turbine and use that force to move from place to place - sensing a toxin? Rotate the flagella and move - this does not happen without the simple single celled organism storing a map of its own body.

The next layer of sense of self - what's good for me, what threatens my existence - what do I like, dislike - preferences , ideas - identity deepening - more order, more constraints, less choice, easier life - again, we already know even single celled organisms sense gravity, light, toxins, temperature, food, predators, and take context dependent decisions. Not unique to humans or animals. Applicable to all Life.

Now we slowly see identity deepening , hollowing - the infinite Consciousness getting defined further and further, the box around us becoming smaller & smaller. More adjectives, more rules, more notions.

The layers of the ideas of I do increase as order deepens - and we see in humans that it has veered into the point of delusion, where we surrender to this identity, these ideas of Self that are only tools for easier existence within the grand creation, and not the entirety. This is seen biologically too - The Default Mode Network in our brain (string of regions that crudely put, holds identity - who am I , what I like, ideas of good & bad & strings together narratives , stories of I) is the most intrusive in humans of all animals. The DMN is also far from perfect - it creates the delusion of a seamless I - a very clear definition of who I Am - but it is only a patchwork of random memories and details. It has its uses - easier existence within the collective reality. Identity, ideas, biases, rules etc form the Ego - the lens through which we view the world & Self. But we forget that it is only the lens, we believe it is the Truth. When Ego is put at a pedestal, it becomes Delusion & super Deluded we humans are!

So Sense of self clearly is seen in all of Life from RNA, bacteria, plant, to you.

Do particles, photons, chemicals and things too have a Sense of Self? I lean towards Yes. My reasoning -

Each particle, chemical, compound manifests in a specific way, specific variables, with valence electrons and interaction with other molecules based its own valence electron - ie. Have preferences , what I would combine with, what I stay away from. Are they all also not identities? Selfs?

Photon entanglement maybe another proof - photons acting in tune, with each other across distances. The One system manifesting in two places, still acting as One, maybe communicating telepathically, so to speak. Maybe photons are one of the Enlightened Ones.

Further, the dance of creation & destruction ,order generation itself , starts with Awareness - The One - The I - the Intent & desire for order. So the sense of self may very well even transcend this Universe & be applicable to every Universe, every creation, every order pocket, whatever the size, whatever the depth of abstraction.

So the sense of self is seen in every being, maybe even in all & every suborder pocket of this Universe.

Coming to Thought. What is thought again? A biochemical process.
Protein sensors get inputs from the outside world - light, pressure, gravity, touch, toxins etc - these inputs create an ion flux inside the organism, inside the cell. This flux gets ions flowing within subjectively triggering other protein gateways, which in turn subjectively on or off certain genes, this process continues until the point where subjective decisions for actions are taken, passed on back to all the cells and body to perform the action/reaction to the sensory stimulus.

Happens in every being! Prokaryotic cells - do it - take inputs, ions flow, subjective responses generated - and memory is nothing but a repeated pattern of ion flow, the overused routes. And these prokaryotes' thoughts are all pretty much the same as mine - what to eat, where to eat, will I be safe in this place, how to protect myself from predators, where do I find my prey, I want a mate, how to attract a mate & so on…

Humans have this idea that thought equals brain/neuron. It's funny - like calling a photocopier(the actual item) as xerox (a company name). Neurons, brain are hardware. One of the types of hardware that can speed up, streamline the process of thought . In evolution as in society too - hardware gets built after a function exists, solutions get built for the problems.
Ion flow is slower, so it's definitely possible that the over used routes get crowded with ions flowing, Sensory inputs & subjective decision making increasing in number as more subjectivity is getting added - so there comes a need for a separate organ to do those tasks & neurons as high speed tunnels for the ion flow. Function always precedes Form. Thought is not a phenomenon of Neurons or the brain. Neurons and the brain developed to manage the 'Thoughts' better.
And even in humans, it's not just the brain that is 'thinking', each of our cells are still doing the 'thinking' as well, as they have always done.

So, all along we have seen Humans are just another Order Pocket, A manifestation of Awareness, Born out Consciousness itself - not really different from any of these, not really different from other order pockets - not really different from other beings.

But, we all believe humans are so unique. Yes. I do agree with this. Humans are unique. Evidence all around us - we are the only ones that commit large scale destruction of every resource & every other being, we are the only ones that run after artificial things like pride, money. We are the only ones that have completely surrendered to the Ego - the identity of self, ideas , rules, etc - the lens that assists in living within this perceived collective reality. We are the only ones that believe Ego to be the Full truth - again mistaking bucket for the Ocean. That is quite unique to us. We have seen its biological backing in the over active & hyper connected DMN mode of our brains above. Delusion - another emergent phenomenon and aide of Order - maybe the only one unique to Humans.

So what do we do about it? Where do we go from here? What is this innate push & pull , this innate struggle that we all feel within, as we continue living within the tiniest box of order created by humans?

We all feel the Consciousness, Awareness, 'Soul' within us - not distinctively, not clearly, but we feel it - ofcourse we do - we are Consciousness, in Consciousness, of Consciousness, we are the many variations of the same Awareness. We feel the Chaos innate to the Self within us. Something beyond & more fundamental than subjective experiences like pain or pleasure.

The struggle stemming from this drive for Order vs the innate Chaos, entropy on the most fundamental level - this struggle, we share with all manifestations.

Additionally, we humans suffer & cause suffering especially from our Delusions.
Greed - for money, for validation - all attempts to strengthen the assumed identity - all to justify the adjectives we want associated with ourselves - and we don't really want to even embody those adjectives, we only want to be known for it - this delusion that allows us to derive satisfaction from even false validation, which we never attain.

At every step of the way, the question remains - what do I do? What do I choose?
There are ready made answers available - everyone will give one, society gives many - even if not directly, through ideas, stories, morals, values, validation - manipulation.
Even the ones that in their seeking, turn to existing systems & validations of the system, further yet the seeking for truth turning into seeking for evidence of their "enlightenment". But such is the human condition. We are raised into ignorance & delusion, since birth, generation after generation - as our biology dictates too for most part.

It's funny - all these discussions and debates about free will vs destiny, but very few about free will & manipulation.
We assume, all our wants, desires are automatically free will. Another delusion inspite of the obvious evidence seen in our herd mentality & the addiction to validation and our biology - a brain that is the most dopamine addicted of all beings.

The identity we have built for ourselves, our choices, goals, wants all stem from the ideas & ideals that are inflicted upon us as the ideal, as the validatable. What is truly ours? That begets the question - who am I truly?

I had this epiphany one day, as I got in the car with my dog, leaving this very sick dog clearly needing help, even after she/he came to our door step. I didn't change my plans for the dog's Life. I let her/him suffer over what? An idea I had.
This is how karma plays I suppose too , in a human sense -Awareness using beings to do its bidding - but how ? - bring its projects to us - creating life, saving life & causing death and everything in between - the more we participate in projects brought to us, the more of our 'projects' get done too.
For example , I was riding my scooter with a dog sitting on the front & leash in my hand. But I didn't know until a fellow rider pointed out that I had let go of the leash & it was being dragged on the road dangerously close to it being caught in the wheel . It could have easily been a Final Destination scenario. But thank god, thank karma, thank that man for performing a project that Awareness brought in front of him & thank him for being One enough in that moment to identify & engage with Awareness. Now he is a dependable order pocket unit in the grand zero sum scheme of Awareness.

Perhaps, the more One we get, the more we do Awareness's bidding, beyond the judgments & adjectives of the World.

But back to the main epiphany - so I chose to let that dog die a painful death alone. But I feed dogs around my home regularly and have helped some dogs that I've found needing help here & there. People who see me everyday might even tag me 'kind'.

I have been kind, yes. But I have also been unkind - above being just one example - I have chosen to ignore such situations many a times, I have chosen to inflict pain purposefully also, many times. So , what am I then? Kind? Unkind? Cruel?
I realised I was all of those - different at different instances, each instance its own World. So if we look fully, every adjective we believe applies to us- do, but the opposites do too. We humans - again rooted in over active DMN & dopamine addiction - build narratives that appeases our ego - ignoring whatever hard evidence is needed to be ignored irrespective how deep or important they are - just to keep this ego going - a validatable identity, an identity that offers most belonging in the world , even if it is a broken world - because - survival, duh! But being this over-active it takes this Ego to the delusion extreme, which again turns back & puts pressure on the same survival it is trying to ensure. Paradox, paradox, paradox!

So, maybe then our path to Oneness is in first fully Seeing - beyond filters, beyond judgement, beyond Ego - remember that we are the Infinity, several layers removed by Awareness & constraints of the abstraction machine that we are, the Ego of our minds- the ideas I & world we carry & completely surrendered to - unlearn & unbecome all that we have gathered growing up in a completely delusional system.

To unlearn enough to be able to ‘Be’ , ‘just Be’ - so we can look for answers on how to be - who to be - from within our own Self - rather than from the systems established or from the Ego that we carry inside - still a remnant of the same systems.

But ofcourse , one could live in this world, without doing any of these - earn well, be happy, be celebrated - even be validated as ‘enlightened’ if that's the tag Ego desires to strengthen itself with - and go away never knowing Life & Self as vast, deep, immense & infinite as they are, hence never really ‘missing’ anything either.
To each his own, I guess.

Ok. Bye.